8

SELECTION OF FABRIC

8.1 INTRODUCTION

It is very important to know how to select the fabric for any garment because the same kind of fabric can not be used for all types of garments. There are some garments which require particular type of fabric. Kurta-Pajama or a gown can be made of poplin or long cloth but a pant can not be made of these fabrics. A pant needs a thicker fabric which will give a good fall and will hold a good crease. Hence, it becomes necessary to select the right kind of fabric for different garments and some points should be borne in mind when buying the fabric from the market.

8.2 OBJECTIVES

After reading this lesson, you will be able to :-

- select appropritate fabric for garments;
- list the points to be kept in kind while selecting the fabric;
- select appropriate fabric for special garments.

8.3 SELECTION OF FABRIC FOR GARMENTS

There are some points about selection of fabric which should always be kept in mind while designing a garment or when advising a customer about a garment. These are -

1. Colour and taxture

While selecting the colour and texture of the fabric, always consider the complexion

and the build of the person who will wear the garment. The colour selected should suit the wearer and the texture of the fabric will depend on the figure of the wearer.

2. Design

The age and the social status of the person influence the selection of the design of the fabric.

3. Age of wearer

The age of the wearer influences the selection of the fabric. For example, nursery prints or flowery designs in large prints and bright colours are appropriate for children's garments. Ladies prefer light designs while light colours, thin stripes and small checks seem more appropriate for older persons. The persons of older age group also prefer loose garments hence the fabric selected should be fine and light.

4. Occupation

People working in offices prefer to wear plain clothes in light colours whereas workmen would want their garments to be made of thick fabrics in dark colours. Hence the occupation of the person influences the selection of fabric.

5. Occassions

Brigthly coloured fabric in bold designs seem more appropriate for festivals and other happy occassions whereas black or plain white seems more suitable for unhappy or unfortunate incidents like death, etc.

While selecting a fabric, please check to see that -

1) the fabric has an even weave

2) that the design is well done throughout the fabric.

8.4 SELECTION OF FABRIC FOR DIFFERENT GARMENTS

There are some points to consider while selecting the fabric for different garments if we want the final garment to look attractive and good to wear. These are -

1. Frock

Children garments need a soft fabric. Fabrics like rubia, crepe, cotton, terrycot,

flannel, voil, poplin, etc. can be used for making frocks. Silk and organdy can also be used for making frocks but they should be used with a lining so that the stiff fabric does not hurt the skin. Nowadays cotswool and satin are also used to make winter frocks.

2. Night suit

These are used at night. Fabrics like flannel, wash-n-wear, rubia, terrycot and voil can be used to make night suits.

3. Skirt

Fabric like terrycot or cotton can be used to make skirts. Slightly thicker fabrics are used to make pleated and divided skirts so that the pleats can be properly pressed and set into place. For these, tussar, khadi, crepe, corduroy, etc. fabrics can be used.

4. Pant (jeans)

Thick fabrics are used to make pant (jeans). The denim fabric is used to make jeans. Denim is of two kinds - one is soft and the other is slightly rougher. The soft denim is used to make jeans for children. Fabrics like drill, tussar, khadi, crepe and corduroy are used for making pants and knickers.

5. Gent's shirt

A wide variety of fabrics can be used to make gents shirts, such as - terrycot, serge, cotswool, cotton, khadi, silk, etc. The fabric chosen can be thick or fine according to the season.

6. Gent's kurta pyjama

Fine and soft fabrics are used for making gent's kurta-pyjamas. Fabrics like terrycot, poplin, cotton, khadi, silk and mulmul are generally used.

7. Blouse

Fabrics like rubia, terryrubia, terrycot, terrysilk, silk, etc can be used for making a blouse. Sometimes sarees have a matching blouse piece but they have to be made with a lining.

8. Ladies suit

There is a wide variety of fabrics with different names available in the market today. Fabrics like silk, terrycot, khadi, crepe, satin, georgette, terrylene, shaneel,

etc. can be used for making ladies suits. In winters, suits can be made of thicker fabrics like cotswool, spun etc.

9. Nighty (gown)

Soft fabrics are used for making a nighty. Fabrics like terrycot, poplin, khadi, cotton, etc are used for this purpose. A fine fabric like net can also be used when making a double set of nighty and gown. Fabrics like linen and cotton can be used for making gowns.

WHAT YOU HAVE LEARNT

In this lesson you have learnt about the points to consider while selecting fabrics for garments and the kinds of fabrics which can be used for making various garments.

Do and See

Select suitable fabric for the following :

i) Pant

ii) Frock

8.5 TERMINAL EXERCISE

1. Describe in detail how you would select fabric for garments?